令和７年度

熊本県立大学 文学部 英語英米文学科

一般選抜（前期日程） 個別学力検査

英語

問 題 用 紙

（１） 試験中は、試験監督者の指示に従ってください。
（２） 問題用紙は、この表紙を含めて11ページあります。
（３） 試験開始の合図があるまで、問題冊子を開いて中を見てはいけません。
（４） リスニング問題は、Part 1 と Part 2 で成り立っています。リスニングの試験は、試験開始時刻から30分経過後に開始します。
（５） 解答は、すべて別紙解答用紙に記入しなさい。解答用紙は、７枚あります。各ページの指定の欄に、受験番号、氏名を記入しなさい。
（６） この問題冊子は、持ち帰って結構です。
（７） 答案回収時に解答用紙を提出しない場合、本科目は採点されません。

（入試問題は、４ページからです。）

（入試問題は、４ページからです。）

【1】 これは英語を聴き取る力を試す問題です。問題は、Part 1 と Part 2 があります。指示に従って解答しなさい。この問題は試験開始時刻から30分経過後に始めます。

Part 1. Listen to the conversation, and answer the questions in ENGLISH. You will hear the conversation three times.

In the conversation, a woman is in a store, talking to a shopkeeper.

Questions:

1. What does the woman want to buy?

2. When will the sold-out item arrive at the shop?

3. Why does the woman want the particular item?

4. What does the woman say about the taste of the Italian cheese?

5. What does the woman do in the end?

Part 2. Listen to the passage, and answer the questions in **ENGLISH**. You will hear the passage three times.

Questions:

1. What has represented the bear unfairly? Give an example.

2. What happened in the Pyrenees Mountains in 2004?

3. What do educational books do concerning bears?

4. Where can Winnie the Pooh and Paddington Bear be found?

5. What was eliminated many centuries ago in Britain?

【2】 次の英文を読んで設問に答えなさい。

One of the most common reasons many people give for not even trying to learn a language is that, once someone passes a certain age, learning a new language is pointless. This almost feels like common sense. 'Children are better language learners', people often tell me, 'and after a certain age you simply can't learn a language.'

I know I certainly felt too old already, even at the age of twenty-one. However, the idea has never held any water or been demonstrated as true by any serious scientific study. Instead there is only a general trend of adults not learning languages as well as children — but this may be true for ①reasons totally unrelated to age. Adults struggle with new languages most especially because of a misguided learning approach, their learning environment, or their lack of enthusiasm for the task, all of which can be changed.

[A] in a second language is definitely possible for *all* ages. The 'I'm too old' excuse is one of many self-fulfilling prophecies* we'll be coming across in this chapter. By telling yourself you are too old, you decide not to put in the work and, thus, don't learn the language. ②The vicious cycle continues.

③The idea that babies have an advantage over us because their brains are hardwired** to learn languages while ours aren't is also not the case. No matter what language you are taking on, ④you have a vast head start on any baby learning that language, simply because you cannot start from scratch as an adult learner. Starting from scratch is what is truly impossible. There is a huge difference between learning your first language and learning your second. Without the thousands of words that your second language may have in [B] with your first, a baby has to do much more work, work that we adult learners so merrily take for granted.

It took you years to be able to confidently distinguish between all the sounds in your native language. When you start to learn a new language as an adult, there are so many learning processes you get to skip that babies have to spend years working on. How about not needing to learn how to distinguish between sounds like an *m* and an *n*? Or all the other sounds that the majority of languages have in common? You also don't have to concern yourself with developing the muscles in your voice box and tongue in order to even *attempt* to make noises with them. Or with training your ear to be able to distinguish between male and female voices, or between the particular voices of family members and friends, not just other noises in your environment. [1]

Adult language learners also have the [C] of already having been exposed to years of context in universal human interaction, which indicates when someone is angry, shouting, or asking a question, or the many other aspects of international body language, intonation, and speech volume. ⑤One study at the University of California, Los Angeles, actually found that an incredible 93 percent of communication of emotions is nonverbal. And a majority of nonverbal communication is universal. [2]

While it's possible that some of these communication cues are built into our DNA to be recognized automatically, babies still need to develop them. They have all this extra work ahead of them, learning how to communicate in general terms before they can even begin to incorporate specific language blocks like vocabulary and grammar. [3]

But a language is not just vocabulary and grammar; it's an entire spectrum of communication, from the clothes we wear to our posture, hand gestures, personal space, pauses, volume, intonation, and a host of other verbal and nonverbal cues, most of which are universal among modern cultures. (There are definitely exceptions, but if you compare them to the number of similarities, the latter will greatly outnumber the former.)

An infant picks all of this up over many years before he or she can adequately communicate with adults and other children. This means we adults have much more time and energy to focus on the much smaller aspects of communication, of how words go together. Babies have it hard, and young children still need serious tweaking, even at the age of six or so. This is why it takes years before children can be considered good speakers. [4]

(Adapted from Benny Lewis. *Fluent in 3 Months: Tips and Techniques to Help You Learn* Any *Language*. Collins, 2014, pp. 24–27.)

* self-fulfilling prophecy: something that becomes true because people believe it

** hardwired to do something: born with the ability to do something

問1. 下線部①の例を、本文から一つ日本語で挙げなさい。

問2. [A] ～ [C] に入る最も適切な語を以下の１～４から選び、数字で答えなさい。

A.	1. Competition	2. Disability	3. Exception	4. Fluency
B.	1. common	2. opposition	3. sequence	4. turn
C.	1. advantage	2. capability	3. issue	4. problem

問3. 下線部②が指す内容として、最も適切なものを以下のａ～ｃから選び、記号で答えなさい。

a. 一つの言語で失敗した場合、他の言語も学ぼうとしないこと

b. どんなに頑張っても、自分より子どもの方が上達が早いと落胆すること

c. 年齢を理由に言語学習に力を入れていなくてその言語を身につけることができず、言語を身につけられないことをまた年齢のせいにすること

問4.　下線部③を日本語に訳しなさい。

問5.　下線部④が指す内容として、最も適切なものを以下のａ～ｃから選び、記号で答えなさい。

a.　成人の脳は赤ちゃんの脳より遥かに大きいので、もっとはやく学ぶことができる。

b.　成人は、言語を学ぶのに必要な知識の多くを既に持っている。

c.　成人は、学習しようとする言語がそれ程必要ないと思ったときに怠惰になる。

問6.　下線部⑤で発見されたことを本文に即して日本語で述べなさい。

問7.　著者は、“language” には複数のコミュニケーションの要素が含まれていると考えている。それらの要素のうちから五つを日本語で挙げなさい。

問8.　最後の二段落に基づいて、言語習得に関する “adults” と “babies” の違いを、40-60語（words）の英語で書きなさい。

問9.　“A laugh is a laugh, across the world.” という文が入る最も適切な場所を [1　　]、[2　　]、[3　　]、[4　　] から選び、数字で答えなさい。

【3】 Read the following passage and answer the questions in **ENGLISH**.

Would you enjoy sitting alone in an empty room for 15 minutes with nothing to do? Most people would not enjoy this experience. In fact, one study showed that 67 percent of men and 25 percent of women preferred to give themselves electric shocks rather than sit [a] in an empty room. Boredom is generally viewed as an unpleasant feeling, but is being bored actually a bad thing?

Many people feel dissatisfied, restless, and uncomfortable when they are bored. This makes them look for b) distractions, such as using social media, playing video games, or watching movies. However, such activities are short-term solutions which, like an addiction, can lead to more intense stimulation being needed to avoid boredom in the future. This is why boredom is often associated with fast-developing self-control problems, including drug abuse, gambling, and binge-eating. However, while the negative aspects of being bored are well-known, there are also some benefits to experiencing boredom which are often overlooked. These include improving our mental health, our creativity, and our desire to try new things.

At a time when there is so much information readily available, especially on our phones, we can feel overloaded and this can cause stress. Also, scrolling through social media can make us more competitive and feel like our lives are not as good as the unattainable, perfect lives that everyone in our social media feeds seems to have. This habit is sometimes called "doomscrolling," and c) it can leave us feeling frustrated, depressed, and even angry. However, taking a break from social media long enough to feel bored can be a valuable opportunity to reduce these negative feelings. Experiencing boredom can reduce the negative effects of social media by helping us build tolerance of less-than-perfect situations. This increased tolerance is correlated with the development of self-control skills and allows us to manage our frustrations and regulate our emotions better. This is especially important for children, so experiencing boredom can help them to develop valuable skills they will need later in life.

It has also been found that boredom can increase creativity and problem-solving skills by encouraging people to actively think and reflect. In one study, when people were made to do boring tasks they used their imagination more and thought in a variety of different ways. This shows that d) boredom and the absence of external stimulation can lead to creative ways of thinking and the discovery of new ideas. According to neuroscientist Alicia Walf, ideas that we may have had in our minds for a long time can be focused on when we are bored. [e], they become better developed. Many inventors, artists, and thought-leaders, including Archimedes, Picasso, and Steve Jobs, claimed that their most creative ideas came to them when they were bored or doing unexciting things like gardening or having a bath.

Boredom can also motivate people to try and find new and exciting things to do. It is the feeling of boredom and dissatisfaction that makes humans curious and willing to challenge

f) established ideas and practices. Being bored also encourages us to change our goals and projects to others that are more fulfilling than the ones we are currently pursuing. On a societal level, this can lead to great achievements and advances. On a personal level, it can help us get to know ourselves better.

Given these benefits, perhaps we should embrace boredom. In Italy this is called "*il dolce far niente*," translated as "the sweetness of doing nothing." Author James Clear writes that we should try to "fall in love with boredom." But many people are finding g) this increasingly difficult to do, especially when work, chores, and other tasks are becoming more time-consuming in our modern lives. It is also important to acknowledge that just being bored will not positively impact on our lives. Rather, it is how we react to the boredom that is most important. If we can approach boredom in a proactive* way and view it as an opportunity to do something beneficial that will help us in some way, we could all see an increase in our mental strength, creativity, and motivation to expand our horizons. So, next time you feel bored, do not reach for your phone, but instead ask yourself, "How can I use this as an opportunity to better myself?"

(Adapted from Anthony Sellick, James Bury, and Kaori Horiuchi. *Grand Tour: New Discoveries*. Seibido, 2024, pp. 25-27.)

* proactive: making things happen or change rather than reacting to events

1. Which expression fits best in [a]? Choose the most appropriate answer from A–D.
   A. excitedly
   B. helplessly
   C. quietly
   D. splendidly

2. Which expression is closest in meaning to underline b)? Choose the most appropriate answer from A–D.
   A. activating your computer
   B. checking something
   C. killing time
   D. searching for solutions

3. What are three benefits of boredom? Fill in the blanks in the following sentence.
   Boredom improves (1)_____, (2)_____, and (3)_____.

4. How does scrolling through social media make us feel?

5. What should we do in order to deal with a situation like underline c)?

6. Why can the author make a claim like underline d)?

7. Which expression fits best in [e]? Choose the most appropriate answer from A–D.
   A. Consequently
   B. Nevertheless
   C. Rather
   D. Regardless

8. Which word is closest in meaning to underline f)? Choose the most appropriate answer from A–D.
   A. essential
   B. internal
   C. rational
   D. traditional

9. What does underline g) refer to?

10. Do you think that boredom or having nothing to do is important to you? Write your opinion with reasons in 50–70 words.

（余白）

（余白）

（余白）

（余白）